

Multiple sign-in for Gmail

Google officially announced multiple sign-in feature for Gmail. You can now sign-in up to three accounts simultaneously

Filter spam

Blogger gets a brand new comment system that lets you filter spam with ease

Google Wave shuts down as Gmail gets a remake

At Google I/O 2009, the crowds cheered as Google unveiled Wave. This was supposed to be the future of communication. Now we hear Google is pulling the plug on this amazing project as they have not managed to garner the kind of adoption they anticipated.

Google had a great vision for Wave, which tried to incorporate all forms of communication that people tend to perform over the internet, email, instant messaging, collaboration on documents and other projects and even gaming. How do you integrate all this though, without making the system overly complicated to use? Google Wave tried to be everything at once, and was never simple enough to use for any. Google tried to promote it

as too much at once, and barely ever to the larger crowd that actually uses Gmail.

Using Wave meant you had to use an additional means of communication, since it was never ready to replace anything, so why would people switch? After a point the burden of using an additional means of communication just to reach a small group of people you know wasn't worth the features it came with.

What Google should have done instead is to make it easier for people to move to Wave. Not just with email notification, but by integrating email directly in Wave. Many more people would have been ready to switch to Wave if they could have used it to send and receive email, while also getting the improved features while communicating with other with

After much hype last year, Google's ambitious communication suite – the Wave has been abandoned. There's word, however, of similar functionality on other Google products

Google accounts. It could gracefully degrade when dealing with non-Wave accounts while offering enhanced features to the rest. We believe they might be giving up too fast.

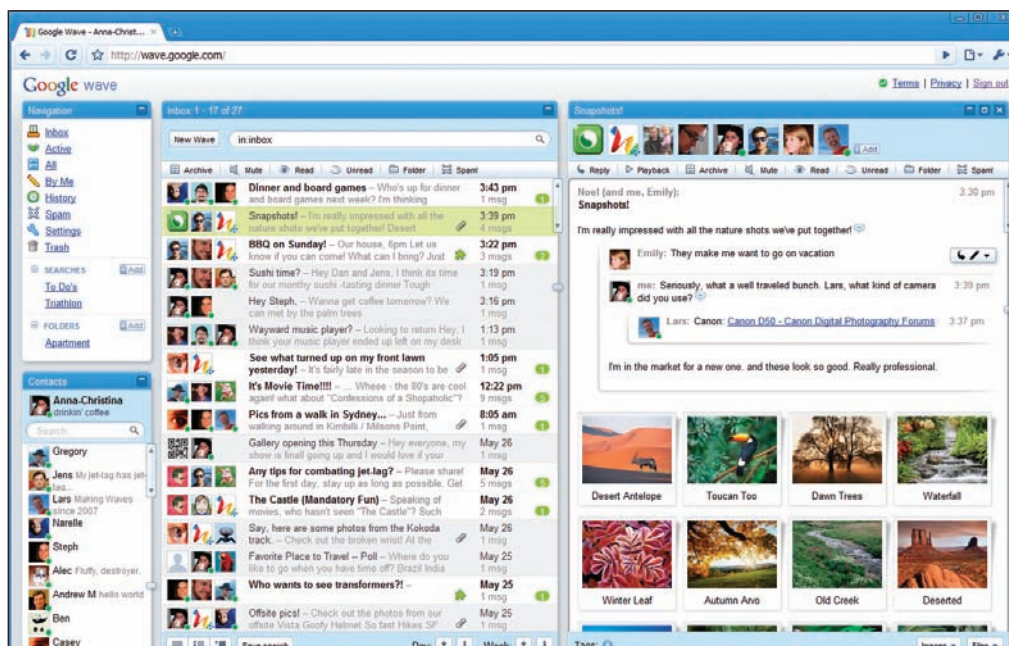
While Google Wave will only be maintained for this year, Wave's new features will live on in other Google products. Of course since Google Wave was open source, other servers and services providing the functionality can live on, and other companies can continue developing where Google will leave off.

GMail though continues to be the star performer it always

was, and Google has now done a major renovation of the interface. The new new interface makes Gmail look and behave even more like an application. The contacts manager has received a major overhaul and new has enhanced editing and merging features.

The changes aren't just in looks. Google has also been adding new functionality to Gmail recently. To give it an even better application-like feel, support for dragging and dropping attachments has been added. Earlier you could attach files to emails in Gmail by dragging them to the Gmail window; now you can also do the reverse, you can drag attached files from emails to any folder on your computer, to have them download there.

Finally, one of the major new features to be added, not only to Gmail, but quite a few other Google services as well, is multiple-account sign-in support. If you have multiple Google or Gmail accounts, you can now now be signed in to all of them simultaneously. Many Google applications will display a drop down which will allow you to select the account you want. This way you can switch between multiple accounts on the fly, and even have two Gmail accounts open in two tabs / windows of the same browser. **d**



Wave or drought?